

While Madina's federal loans and work-study are the same at each school, her scholarships are a bit different. Some schools have very large endowments (lots of money to give away) and will offer students much more money in scholarships and assistance than other schools. It's also important to remember that not all of the money in your financial aid package is free; you need to pay back the loans. Now, let's take a look at Figure 3.3 to see each school's actual cost of attendance and compare it to her total financial aid plus her expected family contribution to examine how much Madina will need to borrow to pay for her education.

	CSU San Diego	University of Oregon	NYU
COA per year	\$30,240	\$56,688	\$78,744
Financial aid + EFC per year	\$23,500	\$28,500	\$28,500
Need per year	\$1,240	\$22,688	\$44,744
Federal loans per year	+ \$5,500	+ \$5,500	+ \$5,500
Total borrowed per year	\$6,740	\$28,188	\$50,244
Total borrowed over four years	\$26,960	\$112,752	\$200,976

 Aid that does not need to be paid back

 Aid that does need to be paid back

Figure 3.3. Cost of attendance with total financial aid by school

The most important thing to examine here is the total borrowed over four years, which was found by adding the "Need per year" with the "Federal loans per year" and multiplying the sum by four years. As you can see, there is a huge difference